very optimistic about it, but the fact is that the textbook was a distressing failure. For one thing, just about the time it came out, two other new biochemistry texts appeared—West and Todd's Textbook of Biochemistry and White, Handler, Smith, and Stetten's Principles of Biochemistry. Each was longer and better than ours. And even if the two competitors had not appeared on the scene, ours just wasn't good enough.

10

The year 1952 saw McCarthyism at its peak in the United States. At no time did it affect me directly in any way, but the spectacle sickened me. My liberal friends and I denounced Senator Joseph R. McCarthy to each other and if we were representative samples of American public opinion he wouldn't have lasted five minutes. The fact is we weren't. The average American was all for McCarthy and his simple-minded and destructive "patriotism."

I remembered what Ted Sturgeon had once said at a convention— that science fiction was the last bastion of freedom of speech. The censor minds did not read science fiction, could not understand science fiction, and would not know what to suppress if they did read it. If censorship ever got so sophisticated that even science fiction fell prey to it, then all was over. Every vestige of democracy would be gone.

So I set about giving my opinion of McCarthyism in a science-fiction story. I called it "A Piece of Ocean" at first, then changed the name to "The Martian Way." It dealt with Martian colonists with a problem, who were victimized out of a solution by a McCarthy-style politician and who were in this way forced to find a still better solution. I finished it on June 10.1 did the 18,000 words in four weeks.

In this story, by the way, I described a "space walk" in euphoric terms, over a decade before space walks actually took place and apparently did induce euphoria.

11

As it turned out, my 1951 income tax was the last one I was ever to make out entirely by myself. It was clear that my 1952 income was going to be large enough to make it advisable to get professional help.

Maury Cohen (whom we had met in Birch toft) recommended the firm of Gorsey and Woll to me. I went there and Sam Gorsey worked out my estimated income tax for 1952 for me. In later years, his junior partner, Saul